

## Asia week ahead: China releases data on GDP, trade, retail sales, housing prices

It's all about China next week as Asia's biggest economy releases key data on GDP, trade, retail sales, housing prices and industrial production amid intensifying headwinds from the Middle East



### Asia Research highlights of the week

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[CNY at a glance: China's yuan moves into our bullish scenario](#)

[Philippines inflation inches up, with oil driven risks building](#)

### China: Moderation in growth is expected

Almost all of China's key data is set for release. We start with China's trade data on Tuesday. We expect the very strong export growth in the first two months of the year to moderate in March, with exports up 8.8% year-on-year and imports up 10.1%, resulting in a trade surplus of \$108.2bn. On Thursday, China releases its first-quarter GDP. We're currently looking for growth to slow to 4.7% YoY in the January-March period, down from 5.0% in the fourth quarter. China's monthly

activity data and 70-city housing prices will be released on Thursday. Other than industrial production, which we expect to grow around 5.5% YoY, economic activity data is likely to remain rather soft in March. Retail sales are projected to slow to 2.5% YoY, while fixed asset investment is expected to remain subdued at around 1.9% YoY year to date. Housing prices are expected to stay in negative territory, but any moderation in the downturn would be an encouraging sign.

## Key events in Asia next week

| Country                   | Time (GMT+8) | Data/event                            | ING   | Prev.   |
|---------------------------|--------------|---------------------------------------|-------|---------|
| <b>Monday 13 April</b>    |              |                                       |       |         |
| Indonesia                 | 1100         | Feb Retail Sales Index (YoY%)         | -     | 5,7     |
| <b>Tuesday 14 April</b>   |              |                                       |       |         |
| China                     | 1100         | Mar Exports (YoY%)                    | 8,8   | 21,8    |
|                           | 1100         | Mar Imports (YoY%)                    | 10,1  | 19,8    |
|                           | 1100         | Mar Trade Balance (USD bn)            | 108,2 | 213,6   |
| India                     | 1430         | Mar WPI Inflation (YoY%)              | -     | 2,13    |
| Singapore                 | 0800         | Q1 GDP Flash (QoQ%/YoY%)              | -/-   | 2.1/6.9 |
| <b>Wednesday 15 April</b> |              |                                       |       |         |
| India                     | 1830         | Mar CPI Inflation (MoM%/YoY%)         | -/-   | 0.1/3.2 |
| South Korea               | 0700         | Mar Unemployment Rate                 | 2,7   | 2,9     |
| <b>Thursday 16 April</b>  |              |                                       |       |         |
| China                     | 1000         | Mar Fixed Asset Investment (YoY% ytd) | 1,9   | 1,8     |
|                           | 1000         | Mar Industrial Output (YoY%)          | 5,5   | 6,3     |
|                           | 1000         | Mar Retail Sales (YoY%)               | 2,5   | 2,8     |
|                           | 1000         | Q1 GDP (YoY%)                         | 4,7   | 4,5     |
|                           | 1000         | Mar Unemployment Rate                 | -     | 5,3     |
| Australia                 | 0930         | Mar Unemployment Rate                 | -     | 4,3     |
| <b>Friday 17 April</b>    |              |                                       |       |         |
| Singapore                 | 0830         | Mar Balance of Trade (SGD bn)         | -     | 4,5     |

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